KEREM ATEŞ

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PROFILE

Linguistics graduate from Boğaziçi University who builds natural language processing (NLP) and machine learning systems, with a background in large language model (LLM) evaluation. Fine-tunes and evaluates transformers (DistilBERT, mBERT, XLM-RoBERTa), including cross-lingual and zero-shot transfer, with ablations and negative results reported as found. Ships complete systems in Python and TypeScript, from a local LLM research pipeline to a free desktop app. Native level English (YDS 98.75 / 100).

EDUCATION

Boğaziçi University | *B.A. in Linguistics* Graduated: 2025

Senior Thesis: *"Acceptability Judgments of Turkish Word Order: A Comparative Study of Native Speakers and Large Language Models."*

- Designed a study with 73 native Turkish speakers and tested 5 large language models (GPT-4o, Claude 3.7 Sonnet, Gemini 2.0 Flash, Grok 3, DeepSeek V3) on the same sentences, looking at word order and animacy.
- Found that language models match human preferences for normal word order, but are less sensitive to animacy and gradual acceptability than human speakers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gini Talent | *AI Data Annotator & Evaluator* February 2025 – September 2026 | Istanbul / Remote

- Checked the quality of a client's LLM outputs through human feedback, judging consistency, accuracy, and language quality across multiple languages, and used Excel to organize and report on large evaluation datasets.
- The client I did this work for cannot be named, as I am bound by a non-disclosure agreement.

Appeal Club | *Suspension Specialist & Co-Founder* 2023 – 2025 | Remote

- Co-founded a startup that helped Amazon sellers resolve account suspensions, bridging Amazon Seller Support and Turkish sellers across the Turkish-English language barrier.

Kültür Sanat Duvarı | *Head Editor (Voluntary)* 2021 – 2024 | Remote

- Volunteer head editor of kultursanatduvari.com, a culture and arts publication: ran daily editorial operations and content planning and managed a team of 13 editors.

SELF-EMPLOYED WORK

Independent Software Developer June 2024 – Present | Remote

- Ship end-to-end software independently: a free Windows and Mac study app with signed self-updates, a self-hosted local-LLM research system, a bilingual client website on a custom domain, commercial TradingView indicators, and MetaTrader 5 and Streamlit trading tools.
- Handle the full development lifecycle independently, from Python prototyping and backtesting through to live deployment and commercial distribution.

Quantitative Trader January 2021 – Present | Remote

- Develop and trade systematic strategies across forex, futures and contract for difference (CFD) markets, managing the full research-to-execution workflow, hypothesis testing, multi-year backtesting, and live deployment.
- Apply structured risk management: defined R:R targets, position sizing rules, and trade logging for ongoing performance review.

E-Commerce (Dropshipping) 2020 – 2022 | Remote

- Ran an independent dropshipping business selling AliExpress-sourced products on Amazon Singapore, handling listings, pricing, and fulfillment from sourcing to delivery.

PROJECTS

Flagship Projects

- **Voynich** (Next.js, TypeScript, SQLite): free local-first study app for Windows and Mac: session timer and goals, linked notes with a graph, a library with ISBN and DOI lookup, a PDF and EPUB reader, flashcards, an optional local-LLM tab, daily backups and signed auto-updates. cliteka-cell.github.io/voynich-releases
- **AI Investor: Local LLM Research System** (Python, Ollama, DeepSeek R1 32B): self-hosted, local-LLM-only investment research system with a three-layer screener, a paper portfolio and 18 scheduled jobs; research only by design, and it grades its own picks against passive benchmarks. github.com/cliteka-cell/ai-investor-writeup
- **Confluence Array: TradingView Indicator Suite** (Pine Script v6): commercial multi-signal indicator sold at confluencearray.com. confluencearray.com

AI & NLP

- **Zero-Shot Multilingual NER** (Python, XLM-RoBERTa): cross-lingual NER transfer to Turkish, German, and Arabic with no target-language labels, zero-shot F1 of up to 0.77 (Turkish), 0.75 (German) and 0.50 (Arabic); the ablation shows plain fine-tuning beats the contrastive alignment on German and Arabic. github.com/cliteka-cell/zero-shot-multilingual-ner
- **Turkish NLP Benchmark** (Python, mBERT, BERTurk): three-way Turkish sentiment benchmark, BERTurk reached 94.3% accuracy. github.com/cliteka-cell/turkish-nlp-benchmark
- **Named Entity Recognition with DistilBERT** (Python, HuggingFace): fine-tuned model for finding names of people, places, and organizations in text, F1 score of 0.82. github.com/cliteka-cell/ner-wikiann
- **Stance Detection with DistilBERT** (Python, HuggingFace): fine-tuned model classifying debate arguments as for or against a topic, F1 score of 0.90. github.com/cliteka-cell/stance-detection
- **ARMAS RL Trading Agent** (Python, MaskablePPO): reinforcement learning agent for trading, with documented negative results. github.com/cliteka-cell/armas-rl
- **ALES Oracle** (Python, Gemini 2.5 Flash, Gemini 3.0): exam-prep tool that generates practice questions and step-by-step solutions from 1,400+ real past ALES questions. ales-oracle.streamlit.app

Data Science

- **House Price Prediction** (Python, XGBoost): machine learning model predicting house prices, R squared score of 0.944. github.com/cliteka-cell/House_Price_Prediction
- **E-Commerce Customer Behavior Analysis** (Python, Pandas): RFM segmentation on 540,000 e-commerce transactions. github.com/cliteka-cell/E-Commerce-Analysis
- **İzmir Acil** (Python, Streamlit): emergency service finder with 4,600+ verified entries, an Open Now filter and GPS distance sorting. izmir-acil.streamlit.app

Trading & Other Projects

- **Peony Nails** (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Netlify): bilingual EN/TR website for a nail studio, live on a custom domain. peonynails.store
- **ARMAS: Algorithmic Expert Advisor for MetaTrader 5** (Python, MQL5, Optuna): mean-reversion trading robot, improved across 18 versions. github.com/cliteka-cell/ARMAS_Project_Full
- **TMSCA** (Pine Script v6): market structure and confluence indicator suite, commercial, in development.
- **Trading Journal** (Python, Streamlit): trading journal with multi-journal support, MT5 report import, analytics and PDF export. trading-journal-preview.streamlit.app
- **Open-Source TradingView Indicators** (Pine Script v6): Naked POC Daily, Session CVD Divergence, Auto Anchored VP, SFP Detector, Market Structure (BOS/CHoCH). github.com/cliteka-cell

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, SQL, R, C#, JavaScript, TypeScript, MQL5, Pine Script

Machine Learning: Scikit-learn, XGBoost, Feature Engineering, Model Evaluation, Ablation & Multi-Seed Study Design, Reinforcement Learning (PPO)

NLP & Transformers: HuggingFace, PyTorch, DistilBERT, mBERT, BERTurk, XLM-RoBERTa, Fine-tuning, NER, Cross-Lingual & Zero-Shot Transfer, Contrastive Learning (InfoNCE), LLM Evaluation

LLM Engineering: Local LLM Deployment (Ollama), Prompt & Context Engineering, Retrieval & Web-Augmented Agents, Scheduled LLM Pipelines, Gemini API

Data Analysis: Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Excel, EDA & Statistical Analysis, Geospatial Analysis (Folium, Geopy)

Web & Deployment: Next.js, Streamlit, Gradio, HuggingFace Spaces, Netlify, SQLite, Prisma, Docker, Desktop Packaging & Signed Updates, Web Scraping

Finance & Trading: Algorithmic Trading, Backtesting, Order Flow Analysis, Volume Profile, Risk Management, MetaTrader 5

LANGUAGES & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Turkish**: Native
- **English**: Native level proficiency (C2)
- **YDS English Certification**: 98.75 / 100 (Level A, highest tier), April 2026, ÖSYM
- **ALES Quantitative**: 70.627, Numerical reasoning university entrance exam, ÖSYM
- **Spanish / German / French**: Beginner (A1)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Interests: AI and data science, computational linguistics, quantitative finance, culture and arts publishing